

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 3 2

♥ Q 8 3

♦ 10 9 6

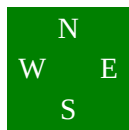
♣ A Q 3

♠ A K 7 5

♥ K J 7

♦ A 8 3

♣ 9 8 2



♠ 10 8 4

♥ 6 5 4 2

♦ K Q J 4

♣ 7 5

♠ Q 6

♥ A 10 9

♦ 7 5 2

♣ K J 10 6 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Win with dummy's ♠Q and force out the ♣A.

The rest of the tricks are yours, nine in all.

If West had only held 2 ♦s it would have been OK to hold up your ♦A just once.

But with this layout you needed to hold up twice.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♦K.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 6

You will need some ♣ tricks to make the contract. If East has 5 ♦s and also the ♣A then you will go down. It doesn't matter if he has the ♣Q because you can finesse him out of that.

But in the case where West has both the ♣ A Q you need to make sure he has no ♦ when he takes his first trick. So hold up the ♦A until the third round, everybody following.

Now start on the ♣s. Play your ♣9 and let it ride. West wins the ♣Q and returns a ♠. Good, he didn't have the fourth ♦.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q 8 2
 ♥ 7 5 3
 ♦ Q 6 4
 ♣ A 9 5

♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 9

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ Q 10 4



♠ J 10 9 4
 ♥ K Q 2
 ♦ A K 9
 ♣ K 7 6

♠ 6

♥ A 10 8 6 4

♦ 10 7 3

♣ J 8 3 2

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

You have lost two tricks so far. Lead the ♠J and let it ride. North wins their third trick with the ♠K but has no ♥ to return so he plays a ♦ which you win with your ♦A.

Play off your 7 winners and give up a ♣ at the end.

The K Q x holding is similar to the A J x holding. It might be two stoppers, or might just be one, depending on which defender next leads the suit.

So you decide whether to hold up or not based on how you expect to play the hand.

With his 4-3-3-3 distribution West chooses not to bother with Stayman. East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♥6. North plays the ♥J.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need to get two more winners. The ♥ suit might provide one of them, but you will still have to establish ♠s. The burning question is whether to win the first ♥ or to hold up. If you take this trick you will have a second stopper if South takes the lead, but you will be in extreme danger if North takes the lead. Since the ♠ finesse has to go into North you should hold up.

North returns the ♥9, South takes the ♥A and clears the suit.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

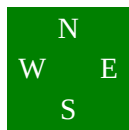
♠ K 3
♥ A 10 8 6 4
♦ 10 7 3
♣ J 8 3

♠ J 10 9 4

♥ 7 5 3

♦ A K 9

♣ A 9 5



♠ 7 6 5

♥ J 9

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ Q 10 4 2

♠ A Q 8 2

♥ K Q 2

♦ Q 6 4

♣ K 7 6

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

With his 4-3-3-3 distribution North chooses not to bother with Stayman. South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥6. East plays the ♥J.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=1 ♦=3 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need to get two more winners. The ♥ suit might provide one of them, but you will still have to establish ♠s. The burning question is whether to win the first ♥ or to hold up. If you take this trick you will have a second stopper if West takes the lead, but you will be in extreme danger if East takes the lead. Since the ♠ finesse has to go into West you should not hold up.

You win with your ♥K, (keeping West in the dark about who holds the ♥Q), enter dummy with the ♦A and play the ♠J, letting it ride to West's ♠K.

West cannot play ♥s without setting up your ♥Q so he will probably exit with a ♣ which you take with the ♣K.

Play off your 6 winners and concede the last three tricks.

This was almost the same as Deal 5, the difference being in which direction the ♠ finesse had to be taken.

But it sure makes a big difference in how you play the hand.

This might have turned out even better. If West had decided to play his partner for the ♥Q, (who would have played ♥J from a holding of ♥ Q J x), you would have made an overtrick!